

You Won't . . .

- **Depend on a huge inheritance or a stroke of luck for your financial independence.** 79% of millionaires received zero inheritance. Only 16% of millionaires inherited more than \$100,000, and only 3% inherited \$1 million or more. So, it's safe to say that at least 84% of millionaires—if not more—built their wealth on their own!
- **Need to have a high-powered, high-paying career to build wealth.** Remember, only 15% of millionaires held senior leadership positions in their careers; the rest—a whopping 85%—were regular people working regular jobs. Also, only one-third of millionaires *never* made six figures in a single working year; only 31% of them averaged \$100,000 a year over the course of their career; and only 7% of them averaged \$200,000 a year over the course of their career.
- **Take crazy, uncalculated risks with your money.** Not a single person in all the millionaires we interviewed mentioned single stock as a major contributor to becoming wealthy, and not one of the 10,000 millionaires we surveyed put single stock in their top three wealth-contributing factors. The number one contributing factor to millionaires' high net worth is investing in retirement plans.
- **Rely on stupid, risky, get-rich-quick schemes.** The average millionaire hit the \$1 million mark for the first time at 49 years old after years—*decades*, in fact—of hard work. Only 5% of millionaires got there in ten years or less.
- **Allow your lifestyle to get out of control and eat up all your money.** Again, 94% of millionaires say they live on less than they make—compared to 55% of the general population.